

# Kirti Bhardwaj

## GoCardless, London — *Tech Lead & Software Engineer*

March 2020 - Current

### Distributed Systems, Scalability and Performance

- **Co-engineered the Postgres to distributed db migration** for core payments monolith (**10M payments on peak days**), so it can scale horizontally.
- **Made the migration pipeline 25x faster** for our **14 TB** dataset (**600 hours down to 24**) by reworking the schema, tuning the database, and digging into YB Voyager's partition filtering and CDC replication issues.
- **Designed and shipped a Postgres function to replace direct pglock queries** in our job system, unblocking 21 high-volume job classes for the YB migration. Validated it against both databases, then rolled it out behind a feature flag (5% to 100%) with a latency probe watching production. **Lock lookup went from ~100ms to ~3ms and P99 latency halved.**
- **Led a cross-team E2E testing effort** to catch edge cases in legacy services, built dry-run tooling with automated fallbacks, rehearsed the cutover repeatedly in production-parallel environments, and agreed readiness criteria with stakeholders for a zero-downtime switch.
- Run **Game Days** to find gaps in our systems, write the runbooks the wider team uses, and onboard engineers inside and outside the team so no one person is a single point of failure.

### Product Engineering (Tech Lead)

- **Tech lead for Digital Experience:** led a team across product, engineering and marketing, acting as product owner, engineering lead and main point of contact for stakeholders. Set the technical direction for a marketing platform with 3M+ monthly visitors and mentored engineers.
- **Owned the merchant sign-up redesign end to end**, across frontend and backend. More than half of merchants dropped out at the top of the funnel because we asked for too much upfront, so I cut the first step down to the essentials and A/B tested each change in Optimizely. **Activation went up 22%.**
- Asking for less upfront meant catching spam another way, so I **built email verification** (schema, API, localised templates, SendGrid quality checks), pwned-password checks, rate limiting, reCAPTCHA and device-ID tracking, and passed spam signals downstream so fake accounts were blocked automatically. This removed a recurring source of incidents.
- **Scoped and planned the referral rewards system** for international growth campaigns, including the technical approach, Optimizely experiments and lifecycle messaging through Braze, then handed it to the team to build with ongoing tech guidance.
- **Planned and led user experience delivery of the company-wide website rebrand**, including scoping, prioritisation and stakeholder updates, and moved our content platform from Prismic to Contentful.
- **Built the monorepo template** (TypeScript, Next.js, React, Lerna) that every new UI project starts from, shrank bundle sizes, raised test coverage to 95%, and contributed to Flux, our component library.
- Cut build times from **60 to 15 minutes** and infrastructure costs by **87%**, and moved services from CircleCI to GitHub Actions, AWS to GCS, and Helm to our internal deploy tooling (Utopia).
- Connected **GA, BigQuery and Looker** so marketing could attribute results across channels.

## KobiTab — *Founder*

February 2026 - Current

- Built and launched a **household brain for macOS** that pulls a family's scattered files, calendars, emails and notes into one place and turns them into actionable tasks.
- Designed it local-first: indexing and search run on-device with no account needed, and AI is optional, so users can bring their own provider or keep inference fully local.
- Built review-before-run agents for everyday family admin like calendar drafting, nanny coordination and chores, plus plain-language answers with cited sources (e.g. shoe sizes, vaccine records).
- Grown to **2,000 users** organically through word of mouth, with no paid marketing.

## PAST EXPERIENCE

### **Walmart Labs** — Software Engineer

**Engineered the Fitment auto-parts widget** using React, Redux, Node.js, and Hapi.js, increasing Add-To-Cart (ATC) conversion by **9%**.

**Automated backend registry services**, implementing custom caching layers and integrating with Centralized Configuration Management (CCM) to improve system throughput.

**Mentored peers and team** on code quality, state management, and testing best practices.

### **Radiolocus, Mumbai and Bangalore** — Tech Lead

**Led a cross-functional team** of 3 frontend engineers and 1 product designer, driving technical roadmap planning, sprint execution, and UI architecture.

**Architected core web applications**, establishing frontend performance standards, component libraries, and automated testing patterns across the team.

**Mentored junior engineers and partnered with product design** to streamline developer-designer handoffs, accelerating feature delivery cadences.

### **Get Jugaad, India** — Co-Founder

**Co-founded an urban logistics and ridesharing platform** for high-density Indian markets while at university; selected as India's official startup in Steve Blank's Lean Startup Initiative to pitch to Silicon Valley investors.

**Led customer discovery, MVP product design, and initial market entry strategy**, building foundational product strategy and prototyping skills straight out of university.

**Wound it down after hitting a regulatory wall**: at the time, Indian law didn't allow charging for rides in privately registered vehicles.

## Side Projects

**Knowledge-base** — A zero-dependency **CLI** tool for organizing project context in markdown. Designed for both human readability and efficient AI agent navigation, featuring automated indexing and lifecycle management.

**Wodehouse-gpt** — A raw PyTorch, character-level GPT-style transformer built without pre-trained models or Hugging Face, trained on classic literary prose.

**Calliope Canvas** — A TypeScript/React framework for building code-driven, interactive technical presentations.

**Session Manager** — A session and bookmark manager utility for different browsers currently live in chrome and firefox app stores